

that their mortal life experience should lead to them making better, more responsible choices.

After the year and a day, the fledgling undergoes the *Saining* (literally, naming) ritual. This rite initiates the changeling into Kithain society, as seers use their command over the Arts to part the Mists and seek out the fae's true name. Should no one have strong enough mastery over the Naming Arts, a changeling may take upon themselves the responsibility to Unleash the Naming untrained, and risk what unpredictable power the Dreaming might impart.

A True Name is the very heart of a changeling, the name that connects her essence to the Dreaming. True Names are highly-guarded secrets, shared only with a changeling's most trusted allies and friends, as knowing a creature's True Name gives someone the power over that creature.

Children of the nobility undergo a slightly different ritual than their commoner cousins, known as the *Fior-Righ*. This secret ordeal, attended only by members of the noble house that sponsored the fledgling, tests the sidhe's physical, social, and mental capabilities to determine what noble house the changeling will join and at what rank. Nobility have a vested interest in assessing their future members early, and therefore often track down and watch potential new sidhe or noble children before their Saining. When possible, nobles may even track these fledglings to their mortal homes to review their capabilities before their training begins.

Once the Saining is complete, a changeling may choose to swear an Oath of Fealty to the freehold, lord, or motley that took them in. There she may take on responsibilities to the household or her motley depending on the skills she's shown during her fosterage. The Chrysalis truly ends with the Saining, as the newly-named changeling emerges as a fully-accepted member of Kithain society, ready to embrace her life as a child of the mortal world and the Dreaming.

Banality

The greatest threat to a changeling is the force of disbelief, stagnation, and confining reason that threatens to choke human ingenuity and creativity. The rationalization that humanity has clung to in an effort to chase away its fears also wears away at the spark of imagination and creation that connects the mortal world with the Dreaming. This grinding, oppressive force is known as *Banality*, and it is the leading cause of destruction for all denizens of the Dreaming. Banality seeks to explain away the fantastic and categorize, empiricize, contain, and render mundane anything outside of the scope of accepted mortal understanding. Older Kithain call this force the Endless Night or the Long Winter, as the encroachment of Banal thought on society renders the world colder to changelings with every passing year.

Banality, while itself not a sentient thing, is a force nonetheless, perpetuated by the press for normalization, sameness, and wearisome acceptance of the status quo that is so part of mortal life. Wherever a teacher stamps out the spark of creativity in a young artist, or a parent demands their child give up on

foolish dreams to "be more practical," there Banality flourishes. For every musician forced to give up on her dreams to take up a nine to five, for every scathing review of that wacky play that makes the writer give up the pen, for every additional week of standardized testing that drives children to frustrated tears, the world becomes a little colder for changelings and mortals alike. Banality makes the mortal mind unable to think beyond the boundaries of its understanding and curbs the creative spark that yearns inside to blaze to life.

The World of Darkness is infused with Banality, frozen in the grip of its power. The pall it throws over everything is reflected in the helpless weariness of its mortal citizens and the stagnating powers that hold its infrastructures in place. For every time a changeling reaches for Glamour and fails to call forth its power, it triggers a response and Banality floods in instead. The Dreaming fades with every moment that Banality tightens its grip, its fierce, uncontrolled beauty catalogued, packaged, and slapped on a factory-stamped lunch box. Banality is the force that is driving the Dreaming and all of its children to extinction, the Long Winter haunting the steps of every Kithain in the mortal world.

Glamour

Glamour is the shining opposite of Banality, the spark of hope that burns bright against the oncoming Endless Night. Glamour is the very stuff of creative life and hope, shining wherever artists work at their passion and mortals battle away the doldrums to dream. Glamour is the basic building block of all fae reality. It powers the Dreaming, makes up every particle of chimerical creatures and creations, and powers all faerie magic. Glamour gives changelings the ability to call up whirlwinds or whisper to trees, create magical flying ships, or allow mortals to see or touch the Dreaming by infusing them with just a touch of power. Glamour is also the basic energy that keeps changelings from losing their fae mien and power. Glamour fuels their *cantrips* (spells) and without a constant stream of Glamour, a changeling forgets her connection to the Dreaming and fades back into her mortal seeming. Though it is vital, the force of Banality in the world has made Glamour scarce. Changelings spend their time finding new sources of Glamour by cultivating mortals that produce it or discovering new locations where natural Glamour flourishes. These locations become a precious resource that must be protected, or the Kithain risk the world becoming that much colder.

Glamour can't be seen in any physical form in its rawest state, as it is a type of energy. Mortals cannot sense Glamour or anything created by it that doesn't have a physical, mortal world counterpart. Because of their connection to the Dreaming, changelings can sense the presence of Glamour. All changelings have at least a little of the faerie sight, called *kenning*, which allows them to see through mortal seemings to the fae mien underneath, and also perceive things infused with Glamour. Glamour can also be collected and pressed into a physical form by changelings to either infuse power into an object, or else to create *dross*, bits of material that store Glamour for use or consumption at a later time. Many a changeling has been saved